not on the formal agenda, as a means of conveying to China that the other party has equal interest and the right to put forward its own issues in the discussion.

Another subtle technique that the Chinese employ in agenda-setting is to suggest that unilateral gestures by the other party prior to the talks may be a good way to ensure positive results in the talks. The actual purpose is to secure unilateral concessions or, if the other side is not willing to do so, then to remove the item from the agenda, thus reducing the other party's leverage. By insisting that India must totally break with the Nationalist Chinese before China would even open diplomatic talks, or by asking that India unilaterally announce the withdrawal of its military escorts in Tibet in 1953 before the negotiations on India's privileges in Tibet, the Chinese were able to remove two important leverages that India had in the negotiations with China. Therefore, paying close attention to agenda-setting and not conceding any negotiating point in advance are important in talks with China on any issue.

China also has other means to influence the agenda for talks. It employs 'non-official' means to signal its unhappiness on a matter in order to put the other party on the back foot before the talks. This could include accusations in their official media, such as the *People's Daily* calling Nehru a Western lackey, or claiming that India was acting on the behest of the Americans and the British in splitting Tibet from China. It might also involve weaving a false narrative such as when the Chinese media suggested during the 1998 nuclear tests and again when the Indo–American nuclear deal was being discussed in the NSG, that India could not legitimately claim the status of a nuclear weapon state because it did not have the capability to produce an atomic bomb prior to 1968. Using the state-run media to run negative messaging allows their officialdom to distance itself by claiming that it is not the official Chinese